

Kingdom Life Ministry presents

The Aleph and the Tav



*Yahshua the Creator, the Almighty,
the First and the Last*

A study of the titles Yahshua claims in Revelation,
where those titles come from in the Prophets,
and why only One Being can lawfully hold them.

KINGDOM LIFE MINISTRY

Restoring YHWH's design for marriage, family, forgiveness, and deliverance

How to Read This Study

Revelation does not end with a doctrine. It ends with a Name, and with a title that only one Being in all of Scripture is permitted to carry.

In the last chapter of the Bible, Yahshua says of Himself: "I am the Alpha and the Omega, the First and the Last, the Beginning and the End." Four verses later He signs His own name to it. That sentence is not a poetic flourish. It is a direct quotation of a self-description that YHWH gave through Isaiah seven hundred years earlier, in a sentence that specifically rules out anyone else holding it.

This study follows that one thread all the way down. Where the title comes from. What it means in Hebrew. What it demands about the identity of the One who speaks it. And how the rest of Scripture confirms the same conclusion from a completely different direction, through the passages that name Yahshua as the Creator of everything that exists.

Quotations follow the World English Bible, which is in the public domain, with the Name restored as YHWH, Elohim in place of God, Yahshua in place of Jesus, Messiah in place of Christ, and Torah or instructions in place of law. Read every passage in your own copy. Do not take this study's word for anything.

A WORD ON TONE

This study names its own weak arguments and hands you the objections before anyone else can. That is deliberate. A case this strong does not need a single stretched verse, and refusing to stretch them is part of walking in truth.

PART ONE

The Three Titles, and Who Speaks Them

Three titles run through Revelation in parallel. Track who says each one, and watch what happens by the end of the book.

Title	Where it appears
Alpha and Omega	Revelation 1:8; 21:6; 22:13
The First and the Last	Revelation 1:17; 2:8; 22:13
The Beginning and the End	Revelation 21:6; 22:13

The opening declaration

Revelation 1:8

"I am the Alpha and the Omega," says YHWH Elohim, "who is and who was and who is to come, the Almighty."

Notice what is stacked into one verse. The title, the eternal existence, the coming, and *the Almighty*. Hold all four together, because they show up again on other lips before the book is over.

Nine verses later, the same title, and a grave

Revelation 1:17 to 18

"Don't be afraid. I am the first and the last, and the Living one. I was dead, and behold, I am alive forever and ever."

There is no ambiguity here at all. The speaker has scars. He walked out of a tomb. And He introduces Himself with the divine title.

Revelation 2:8

"The first and the last, who was dead, and has come to life says these things."

The One on the throne

Revelation 21:6 to 7

"It is done! I am the Alpha and the Omega, the Beginning and the End... He who overcomes, I will give him these things. I will be his Elohim, and he will be my son."

And then the book signs its own name

Revelation 22:12 to 13

"Behold, I come quickly. My reward is with me, to repay to each man according to his work. I am the Alpha and the Omega, the First and the Last, the Beginning and the End."

Revelation 22:16

"I, Yahshua, have sent my angel to testify these things to you for the assemblies."

Revelation 22:13 stacks all three titles into a single sentence, and three verses later the speaker gives His name. Every title that opened the book on the lips of YHWH Elohim the Almighty closes the book on the lips of Yahshua. The book never explains the overlap, never apologizes for it, and never treats it as a problem. It simply assumes what this study is about to prove.

BE HONEST ABOUT THIS ONE

Some translations, following the later manuscript tradition, also place "I am the Alpha and the Omega, the first and the last" in Revelation 1:11. The oldest manuscripts do not have that phrase there, which is why many modern translations omit it. Do not build on 1:11. You do not need it. Revelation 1:17 and 22:13 with 22:16 carry the entire argument on their own, and refusing to use a disputed verse costs you nothing while it buys you enormous credibility.

PART TWO

Why Aleph and Tav

John writes to assemblies who read Greek, so he gives the title in Greek letters. But John is a Hebrew man thinking Hebrew thoughts, and the expression he is translating is a Hebrew one.

Alpha is the first letter of the Greek alphabet. Omega is the last. In Hebrew those positions belong to א aleph and ת tav.

Naming the first and last letters of the alphabet is a Hebrew way of saying *the whole of it, end to end, with nothing left out*. Everything that can be spelled, everything that can be spoken, everything that can be said, is contained between those two letters. To claim them is to claim the entirety.

"Alpha and Omega" is the translation. **Aleph and Tav is the thought underneath it**. And unlike Greek, Hebrew has an actual word spelled aleph-tav, אַתָּה, which appears in the very first verse of Scripture. Part Six deals with that, carefully and honestly.

PART THREE

Isaiah, and Where the Title Comes From

Yahshua is not inventing a phrase in Revelation. He is picking up a signature that YHWH had already stamped on Himself through the prophet, in language that deliberately shuts the door on anyone else using it.

Isaiah 44:6

"This is what YHWH, the King of Israel, and his Redeemer, YHWH of Armies, says: 'I am the first, and I am the last; and besides me there is no Elohim.'"

Isaiah 41:4

"Who has worked and done it, calling the generations from the beginning? I, YHWH, the first, and with the last, I am he."

Isaiah 48:12

"Listen to me, O Jacob, and Israel my called: I am he. I am the first. I am also the last."

In Hebrew the phrase is *ani rishon va'ani acharon*. I am first, and I am last.

This is not a description of a role. It is an exclusive claim, and Isaiah 44:6 attaches the exclusion clause to it in the very same breath: **besides me there is no Elohim**. There is no room left in that sentence for a second holder of the title.

So there are only two possibilities. Either Isaiah was wrong when he said no one else can carry that name, or the One who carries it in Revelation 1:17 and 22:13 is YHWH Himself. There is no third option available, and this is the cleanest form of the argument you will ever preach. Do not complicate it.

The First and the Last Is the Creator

Now the two halves of this study meet. Isaiah does not leave "the First and the Last" floating as an abstract title. He ties it directly to the act of creation, in the same paragraph.

Isaiah 48:12 to 13

"I am he. I am the first. I am also the last. Yes, my hand has laid the foundation of the earth, and my right hand has spread out the heavens."

Read that as one sentence, because that is what it is. The First and the Last is the One whose hand laid the foundation of the earth. The title and the act belong to the same Person.

And then Isaiah closes off the one escape route a person might reach for, which is the idea that YHWH created through some other being acting on His behalf.

Isaiah 44:24

"YHWH, your Redeemer, and he who formed you from the womb says: 'I am YHWH, who makes all things; who alone stretches out the heavens; who spreads out the earth by myself.'"

The Hebrew behind "by myself" is *l'vadi*. Alone. No helper, no assistant, no second party, no agent standing beside Him. Whatever else is true about creation, Isaiah forecloses the possibility that YHWH delegated it.

Now read what the emissaries say about Yahshua

John 1:1 to 3

"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with Elohim, and the Word was Elohim... All things were made through him. Without him, nothing was made that has been made."

Colossians 1:16 to 17

"For by him all things were created in the heavens and on the earth, things visible and things invisible, whether thrones or dominions or principalities or powers. All things have been created through him and for him. He is before all things, and in him all things are held together."

Hebrews 1:10 to 12

"You, Master, in the beginning, laid the foundation of the earth. The heavens are the works of your hands. They will perish, but you continue... you are the same. Your years will not fail."

Hebrews 1:10 is quoting **Psalms 102:25 to 27**, a psalm addressed by name to YHWH the Creator. The writer of Hebrews takes those words and tells us the Father speaks them **to the Son**. That is not an inference drawn by this study. That is the plain claim of the text.

Add **1 Corinthians 8:6**, one Elohim the Father of whom are all things, and one Master Yahshua Messiah through whom are all things.

Set Isaiah 44:24 beside Colossians 1:16 and there is nowhere left to stand. YHWH says He made everything **alone, by Himself, with no one beside Him**. Paul says everything was created **through Yahshua**, with nothing excluded. Both statements are true, and both can only be true at once if Yahshua is YHWH. Any other reading requires one of the two verses to be false.

Said of YHWH	Said of Yahshua
Isaiah 44:6, "I am the first and I am the last, and besides me there is no Elohim"	Revelation 1:17; 2:8; 22:13
Isaiah 48:13, "my hand has laid the foundation of the earth"	Hebrews 1:10, spoken by the Father to the Son
Isaiah 44:24, "who alone stretches out the heavens... by myself"	John 1:3; Colossians 1:16, all things made through Him
Isaiah 40:10 and 62:11, He comes and His reward is with Him	Revelation 22:12, "my reward is with me"
Jeremiah 17:10, "I, YHWH, search the mind, I try the heart"	Revelation 2:23, "I am he who searches the minds and hearts"
Zechariah 12:10, "they will look to me whom they have pierced"	Revelation 1:7; John 19:37
Deuteronomy 10:17, YHWH is Elohim of elohim and Master of masters	Revelation 19:16, "King of kings and Master of masters"

The Almighty

The word rendered "Almighty" in Revelation is the Greek *Pantokrator*, the term the Greek translators used to carry the Hebrew **El Shaddai** and **YHWH of Armies**. It occurs nine times in the book, and Revelation 1:8 fastens it directly to the One who says "I am the Alpha and the Omega."

Now follow that word to Revelation 19, where the rider comes out of heaven.

Revelation 19:13, 15 to 16

"He is clothed in a garment sprinkled with blood. His name is called 'The Word of Elohim.'... He treads the wine press of the fierceness of the wrath of Elohim, the Almighty. He has on his garment and on his thigh a name written, 'KING OF KINGS, AND LORD OF LORDS.'"

The One who is called the Word of Elohim, which John 1:14 tells us became flesh, carries out the wrath of the Almighty and wears the title that Deuteronomy 10:17 gives to YHWH alone.

And in the closing chapter, the reward language is lifted straight out of Isaiah.

Isaiah 40:10

"Behold, the Lord YHWH will come as a mighty one... Behold, his reward is with him, and his recompense before him."

Yahshua says exactly that about Himself in **Revelation 22:12**, one verse before He claims the Aleph and the Tav.

The worship test

Revelation 5:13

"I heard every created thing which is in heaven, on the earth, under the earth, on the sea, and everything in them, saying, 'To him who sits on the throne and to the Lamb be the blessing, the honor, the glory, and the dominion, forever and ever!'"

Set that against Isaiah 42:8, where YHWH says He will not give His glory to another. And set it against what happens twice in this same book when John tries to worship a created being.

Revelation 22:8 to 9

John falls down to worship at the feet of the angel and is told sharply, "See you don't do it! I am a fellow bondservant with you... Worship Elohim."

One book. Worship of an angel is refused on the spot, twice. Worship of the Lamb is received by every created thing in heaven and earth, and nobody stops it. Revelation is internally consistent on this point only if the Lamb is not a creature.

The Aleph-Tav in the Hebrew Text

Here is where this teaching either gets very strong or gets you embarrassed, depending entirely on how carefully you handle it. Read this whole section before you teach any of it.

What is actually there

Hebrew has a small word, אֵת, spelled aleph-tav and pronounced *et*. It sits in front of a definite direct object. English has nothing like it, so translations simply pass over it. It is not translated, but it is there, and it is there from the first verse of the Bible.

Genesis 1:1

"In the beginning, Elohim created the heavens and the earth." Hebrew: *Bereshit bara Elohim et hashamayim v'et ha'arets.*

Seven Hebrew words. The Aleph-Tav appears twice, standing between the Creator and everything He creates.

The strongest single passage

This is the one worth building on, because Revelation itself reaches for it.

Zechariah 12:10

"They will look to me whom they have pierced." Hebrew: *v'hibitu elai et asher daqaru.*

Two things make this remarkable. First, YHWH is speaking, and YHWH says **they pierced Me**. Second, John quotes this verse in

Revelation 1:7, one verse before the Alpha and Omega declaration of 1:8. The pierced One and the Aleph-Tav sit back to back in the opening of the book, and that is a structural fact about the text, not a stretch.

Where teachers overreach, and how not to

HANDLE WITH CARE

Some teach that every occurrence of **𐤀𐤓** in the Hebrew Scriptures is a hidden appearance of the Messiah. That claim collapses the first time an opponent opens a concordance, because the word appears roughly seven thousand times and marks the object of almost any definite sentence, including verses about idols, enemies, and the serpent. If you teach it as a mechanical rule, you will be corrected in public and the rest of your teaching will be dismissed along with it.

Teach it as what it actually is, which is still remarkable. The Hebrew language carries a word made of its first and last letters, and that word stands over the created order from Genesis 1:1 forward. Then let **Yahshua's own claim in Revelation 22:13** supply the authority. He is the one who says He is the Aleph and the Tav. You are not decoding a secret. You are believing a stated claim and then noticing that the language of creation was built to carry it.

Same conclusion, but standing on a claim Yahshua makes out loud rather than on a grammatical particle. Argued that way, it cannot be knocked down.

PART SEVEN

The Tav, the Mark, and the Sealed

In the older paleo-Hebrew script the letters were drawn as pictures. Aleph was drawn as the head of an ox, carrying the sense of strength, first, leader. Tav was drawn as a mark, a cross or an X, the sign you make when you sign something.

That second one is not merely a picture. The Hebrew word *tav* means a mark, and Scripture uses it that way.

Ezekiel 9:4

"Go through the middle of the city... and set a mark on the foreheads of the men that sigh and that cry over all the abominations that are done in its midst." The word for mark is *tav*.

Those who carry the mark are passed over when judgment falls on the city. It is the same shape as Exodus 12, where the blood is applied to the two doorposts and the lintel of the house and the destroyer passes by.

Then follow the mark forward.

- **Revelation 7:3**, do not harm the earth until we have sealed the bondservants of our Elohim on their foreheads.
- **Revelation 14:1**, the hundred forty four thousand, having His name and the name of His Father written on their foreheads.
- **Revelation 22:3 to 4**, "The throne of Elohim and of the Lamb will be in it, and his servants will serve him. They will see his face, and his name will be on their foreheads."

Look closely at the grammar of Revelation 22:3 to 4. One throne, shared by Elohim and the Lamb. Then *his* servants, serving *him*, seeing *his* face, carrying *his* name. Singular all the way through, immediately after two are named. The last page of Scripture places one throne, one service, one face, and one Name, with the Aleph and the Tav standing over all of it.

The Hard Questions, Answered Honestly

You will be handed every one of these. Answer them before they are asked and you will never be on your back foot.

"Revelation 1:8 is the Father speaking, not Yahshua."

Grant it freely. It changes nothing. The argument does not require 1:8 to be Yahshua. It requires only that the title in 1:8 belongs to YHWH Elohim the Almighty, which the verse states outright, and that Yahshua claims the identical title in 22:13, which He also states outright. If the title is exclusive, and Isaiah 44:6 says it is, then the two speakers are one Being. Conceding 1:8 actually makes your case cleaner, because it removes the argument about who is speaking and leaves only the question of who is permitted to hold the title.

"Revelation 3:14 calls Him the beginning of the creation of Elohim, so He was created."

The Greek word is *arche*, which carries origin, source, and rule, not first item produced. The same word describes Yahshua in **Colossians 1:18**, "the beginning, the firstborn from the dead," where it plainly does not mean the first thing ever made. He is the origin of the creation, not a product of it, and the very next chapter of Colossians says all things were created through Him.

"Colossians 1:15 says firstborn of all creation."

Prototokos is a term of rank and inheritance, not chronology. **Psalm 89:27** makes this explicit when YHWH says of David, "I will make him my firstborn, the highest of the kings of the earth." David was the youngest of eight sons. Firstborn there means preeminent heir. And Paul gives his own reason in the very next verse: He is firstborn *because* by Him all things were created.

"Proverbs 8 says wisdom was brought forth, so the Son had a beginning."

Proverbs 8 is poetry in which wisdom speaks as a woman calling in the street. It is not a genealogy of the Messiah, and both sides have historically abused it. Do not build on it, and do not let anyone else build on it against you. The Creator passages in John 1, Colossians 1, and Hebrews 1 are direct statements about Yahshua by name and are not in poetic personification.

"John 1:1 says the Word was with Elohim, so they are two."

The same verse finishes, "and the Word was Elohim." Whatever "with" is carrying, it cannot mean a second Elohim, because two verses later John says all things were made through Him and Isaiah 44:24 says YHWH made all things alone.

"Aleph-Tav is just the direct object marker. Your whole teaching is built on a grammar particle."

Agree with the grammar, and then show that the argument never rested on it. See Part Six. The case is built on Isaiah 44:6 and Revelation 22:13, two plain sentences. The Hebrew particle is a beautiful confirmation, not the foundation. Say that out loud and the objection dissolves.

"First and Last just means He is preeminent."

Not in Isaiah 44:6 it does not, because the same sentence adds "and besides me there is no Elohim." That clause is not about rank. It is about how many exist.

The Whole Thing in One Page

The chain, in five links:

- **Isaiah 44:6.** First and Last is YHWH's own exclusive name, given with the clause "besides me there is no Elohim."
- **Isaiah 48:12 to 13 and 44:24.** That same First and Last laid the foundation of the earth and stretched out the heavens *alone, by Himself*.
- **Revelation 1:17, 2:8, 22:13.** Yahshua takes that title, and in 22:16 signs His name to it.
- **John 1:3, Colossians 1:16, Hebrews 1:10.** Everything that exists was made through Yahshua, and a psalm written to YHWH the Creator is spoken by the Father to the Son.
- **Therefore Yahshua is YHWH**, the Creator, the Almighty, the Aleph and the Tav.

If Yahshua is not YHWH:

- Isaiah 44:6 is false, because someone besides YHWH holds the name of the First and the Last.
- Isaiah 44:24 is false, because YHWH did not in fact create alone.
- Isaiah 42:8 is false, because a created being receives the glory of every creature in heaven and earth in Revelation 5:13.
- Revelation contradicts itself, refusing worship of an angel while permitting worship of the Lamb.

But because Yahshua is YHWH in the flesh:

- The One who spoke the world into being is the One who was pierced for it.
- The First and the Last is the same one who says "I was dead, and behold, I am alive forever and ever."
- The mark of the Tav is not a symbol placed on us by a stranger. It is the Name of the One who made us.

"I am the Alpha and the Omega, the First and the Last, the Beginning and the End." Revelation 22:13. "I, Yahshua, have sent my angel to testify these things to you." Revelation 22:16. The Creator did not send someone to save His creation. He came Himself.

APPENDIX

Complete Reference List

The titles in Revelation: Revelation 1:8; 1:17 to 18; 2:8; 3:14; 21:6 to 7; 22:12 to 13; 22:16

The source of the title in Isaiah: Isaiah 41:4; 44:6; 48:12

YHWH as sole Creator: Isaiah 40:28; 44:24; 45:12; 45:18; 48:12 to 13; Nehemiah 9:6; Job 9:8; Psalm 102:25 to 27

Yahshua as Creator: John 1:1 to 3, 10; 1 Corinthians 8:6; Colossians 1:15 to 18; Hebrews 1:2 to 3, 10 to 12; Revelation 3:14

The Almighty: Revelation 1:8; 4:8; 11:17; 15:3; 16:7; 19:6; 19:15; 21:22; Genesis 17:1; Deuteronomy 10:17

The Aleph-Tav in the Hebrew text: Genesis 1:1; Zechariah 12:10 with John 19:37 and Revelation 1:7

The Tav as the mark, and the sealing: Exodus 12:7, 13; Ezekiel 9:4 to 6; Revelation 7:3; 14:1; 22:3 to 4

YHWH passages applied to Yahshua: Isaiah 40:10 and 62:11 with Revelation 22:12; Jeremiah 17:10 with Revelation 2:23; Zechariah 12:10 with Revelation 1:7; Psalm 102:25 to 27 with Hebrews 1:10 to 12; Deuteronomy 10:17 with Revelation 19:16; Isaiah 45:23 with Philippians 2:10 to 11; Joel 2:32 with Romans 10:9 to 13

Worship and glory: Isaiah 42:8; 48:11; Revelation 5:13 to 14; 19:10; 22:8 to 9

Passages to study on the other side: Revelation 3:14; Colossians 1:15; Proverbs 8:22 to 31; John 1:1; 14:28; 1 Corinthians 15:24 to 28; Mark 13:32

Walk in truth, walk in light. Shalom.

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